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ForumIAS

GENERAL STUDIES

10827 [illegible]

Name Of Candidate	Ishita Kishore		
Roll No.	1910080460	Date:	

Time Allowed: Three Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INDEX TABLE		
Q. No.	Max. Marks	Marks Obtained
1		
2		
3		
4		
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Total:	250	

INSTRUCTION

1. Please do furnish Name, Email, Roll No and Mobile in the answer sheet.
2. There are TWENTY questions printed in ENGLISH & HINDI, all questions are compulsory.
3. The number of marks carried by a question/part is indicated against it.
4. Answers must be written in the medium authorized in the admission Certificate, which must be stated clearly on the cover of this Question-Cum-Answer (QCA) Booklet in the space provided.
5. Word limit in questions, if specified, should be adhered to. Any page or portion of the page left blank in the Question-Cum Answer Booklet must be clearly Struck off.

Any specific messages for ForumIAS Mentors/ Evaluators with respect to your copy? Write it here.

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Evaluator's Discretion:

Total Marks:

Evaluator's Discretion: This is the marks awarded at the discretion of the evaluator based on your overall impression, on the basis of (but not limited to) your handwriting, presentation, use of diagrams, flowcharts, facts and figures or absolutely anything that he/she liked in your copy.

For Student Only

Start Time | 10 AM	End Time | 1 PM
Mode Of Examination:	Online ☑ Offline ☐

For Office Use Only

ECN CODE:	EG:	Evaluation Date:

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Note: You can discuss your evaluated copy with the Mentor. Raise a ticket from your portal to schedule a mentor call or visit the offline centre to meet mentor (all 7 days, Timings – 11 AM to 6 PM). Further if you are unsatisfied with the evaluation, you can seek re-evaluation of the copy.

Parameters	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Average	Poor	Very Poor
Language						
Structure						
Presentation						
Handwriting						
Content						
Attempt						

ADDITIONAL REMARKS

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Section A

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Feminism is for everybody

THE PILL: In 1960, US FDA approved the birth control pill, freeing women from the restrictions of child-bearing. Women were now freer to study or work, became more productive members of society, and prevented themselves from the upbringing of a child for whom they weren't psychologically or financially ready.

When ~~[illegible]~~ half of the population is more independent & efficient, does it not enhance the potential of our aggregate pie? Does bodily autonomy of women not promote a generation of youngsters with sound mental & physical health?

Such questions help us understand how feminism; & everything it stands for can mutually benefit all in society.

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To be a feminist in any authentic sense is to want for all persons, liberation from sexist roles, discrimination & oppression. The first wave of feminism is often marked with the French Revolution & Mary Wollstonecraft (the Mother of Feminism). It was mainly a suffragate movement. JS Mill's work in the "Subjection of Women' raised the pertinent question that even if women were of an inherently different nature, their potential can be tested with the democratic experiment. He believed that confining women to the four walls of family was neither good for women nor society.

In the Indian context, the Vedic Age is seen as the

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Golden Age for women. The story

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of Gargi engaging in a philosophical debate with the King is an indisputable example of how educated women could have a say in policy making.

Yet more than 3000 years later the same land witnesses less than 14% women in its parliament, less than 15% researchers in science and a literacy rate that is 10% lower than that of men. Whether such dismal numbers have any far-reaching repurcussions on all, is explored in the following paragraphs.

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FEMINISM AND ECONOMY : Miles to go before we sleep

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People across the globe have played very different roles in economy based on their gender. This has created enormous differences in power, prestige & status in developing & expressing talents.

Globally women earn only three quarters as much as men despite similar jobs & education. They remain underrepresented in formal sector & over represented in the informal one. They spend twice as much time on household chores & four times the time on child care as compared to men.

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This highlights how women are underutilized, underpaid and overstretched. Amartya Sen has played a pioneering role in paying attention to the "missing women". He emphasizes on the capability approach to bring mainstream women. India's labour force participation rate is astonishingly low at 20%. for the third largest economy in PPP terms Not only that, it is also declining. Empowering women with education, skills, & freedom to make choice can help to boost India's GDP by a whopping 27% as per IMF.

Women's exemplary sense of financial responsibility is showcased

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by the example of women-led Self Help Groups which have a loan repayment rate of 97% which is even better than corporates.

Thus, the need of the ~~FEMINISM & SOCIETY~~ hour is a massive campaign to not just bring women in the workforce but also retain them. As per IAS Smita Sabharwal, the biological clock is ticking simultaneously with the professional clock, so we must bring women friendly policies to help them return to work post pregnancy.

FEMINISM & SOCIETY : A stitch in time can save nine

According to Simone de Beauvoir,

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one is not born woman, but rather

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becomes a woman. Thus, due time in a gendered society where males have preference over females, transgenders & the non-binary. This leads to violence that is specific to gender like ~~gen~~ infanticide, genital mutilation, rapes, and honour killings. Sudha Murthy, who spent more than 20 years battling the Devadasi system in Karnataka, talks about its systemic character.

What everyone fails to realise is that study after study have shown that gender equality benefits society as a whole.

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Feminism in society will make our communities safer, and healthier & more productive which benefits not just women, but children & men with its ripple effects.

In India, NFHS has shown how children with more educated mothers have received better nutrition, and performed well in schools. Mother's education plays a key role in the cognitive development of child along with promoting good social behaviour. It leads to better sanitation practices & higher consciousness for vaccinations. All of these are imperative in reaping benefits from India's demographic dividend.

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Feminism has also helped men by reducing their burden of single handedly running families, participation in wars, inclusion in rape laws, & also reduction in toxic masculinity. Vogue's ad campaign of "Boys dont cry to Boys dont make others cry" not just normalises being emotional for men but also spreads information against violence.

Thus the onus for a more equal society rests not only on women, but also men as it enables them to lead more fuller lives. The world can learn from the example of Indian Cricket team's captain Virat Kohli who set the right example by demanding a paternity leave.

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FEMINISM, POLITICS, LAW : An ounce of protection is worth a pound of cure

Catherine McKinnon famously said "When I look at the state, the state appears male to me". Such contemplations makes one wonder whether the absence of enough women representatives has a one to one relationship with the dismal status of women. With only 78 MPs in Lok Sabha, Delhi is also the rape capital of the world. The fact that sanitary napkins were put under the GST slab initially, raises questions of lack of the women perspective in policy making. The absence of provisions for marital rape in our legal structure makes it a male centric polity.

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Adding ~~the~~ feminism women in our political sphere will not just empower women but also help in making laws gender neutral. The debates around women rights pushed FBI in USA to include men under the definition of rape. In India, feminism has started conversation on granting postal ballot rights to the male spouses of women officers. It was because of Ruth Bader Ginsberg in USA that men were entitled to the same social security benefits as women.

Thus, gender equity in all spheres of life → economic, social, political is not just a matter of inclusivity and justice. Rather

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it is crucial for ensuring the best development & fast tracked progress of humankind. This fight is everyone's responsibility and thus feminism is for all — men, women, non binary, researchers, politicians, students, workers.

"The present era is for strong women, May we know them, May we Raise them, May we be them."

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Section B

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Peace is not absence of war but the presence of justice

After the end of the Second World War, global powers decided to carve up the Korean Peninsula across the 38th parallel. In the aftermath of the war, both nations, we witnessed how both nations chose trajectories in stark contrast to one another. While one is known for its gross violation of human rights the other is a champion of democracy. While one faces gut wrenching poverty the other has unbridled prosperity.

The above example helps us understand that peace is not just an antonym of war or the absence of it. It is rather a much broader term of which a just society forms the basis

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of a just society.

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In this essay, we will will examine the multiple dimensions of peace (apart from absence of war, how ~~peace and~~ presence of justice can ensure ~~justice are mutually reinforcing~~ concepts peace, and how these mutually reinforcing concepts can help overcome conflicts.

ALL THAT GLITTERS IS NOT GOLD

After a gruesome battle, known in our history books as the Kalinga War, King Ashoka emerged victorious. He expected celebration & joy but witnessed pain, misery, orphans, widows & despair.

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Despite winning the war for his people, he did not feel a sense of peace. He embraced ahimsa (non violence). He now followed a pacific policy in his foreign endeavours instead of wars. He ensured justice for the people and not just for pompous victories.

प्रजा सुखे सुखं राजन
प्रजानं च हिते हितम।
नात्मप्रियं सुखं राजन
प्रजानं च हिते हितम॥

(In the happiness of his subjects lies the happiness of the king)

This 2000 years old story of a victorious king tells us neither victory in a war, nor the absence of war can ensure justice.

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Peace has many dimensions.

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While Greek Philosophers believe peace and justice to prevail in a fair allocation of resources, Immanuel Kant gives the categorical imperative of inviolability of human dignity.

We can use both interpretations in Indian context to further understand what peace constitutes.

If an extremely talented sportswoman like PV Sindhu is confined to domestic responsibilities, it would be due to her gender, it will lead to injustice. (Greeks)

Further, if in a peace loving

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country like India. a person does not have access to even two square meals a day, can we say that peace prevails? (Kant)

The same concept can be understood at the macro level. Despite no major war b/w India and Pakistan in decades, Kashmir is still a victim of internet shutdowns lack of timely elections and perennial insecurity. This shows that mere lack of war w/o proactive measures of justice is far from peaceful.

Let us evaluate how justices paves the path to peace

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"PEACE & JUSTICE ARE TWO SIDES OF THE SAME COIN" - Eisenhower

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The heartbreaking ordeal of the migrant labourers in a world hit by the pandemic snatched away peace from all the spectators. It was only after the Government made allocations of food supplies & shelter that a sense of justice prevailed.

Mahatma Gandhi believed that poverty is the worst form of violence. With more than 33% children wasted & stunted and more than 50% women anaemic,

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India needs to fight poverty and malnutrition on a war footing. India's social welfare programmes like MGNREGA, Fair Price Shops, MSP for crops aims to bring justice to millions. The loss of lives in absence of war is due to the gap in justice, eg: farmer suicides, death of children in Muzaffarpur due to malnutrition & J. Encephalitis etc.

Similarly in the international arena, the Afghan war is theoretically over but the presence of an exploitative

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regime like Taliban curtails any progress in peace. The economy has crashed, the pandemic is reeling and malnutrition is widespread. The presence of justice at individual level (free speech, access to basic necessities), community level (freedom to religious minorities) & national level (stability in trade, currency) can chart the path towards peace. India's belief in Vasudev Kutumbakam - The world is one made it donate COVID vaccines to the torn nation under Vaccine Maitri.

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Let us now examine how measures for justice can not only bring peace but also overcome wars.

यतो धर्म ततो जय: | Where there is justice, there is victory

The death of George Floyd, as victim of racism in the US, sparked the Black Lives Matter movement. The movement has been nominated for the Nobel Peace Prize for raising awareness of racial injustice. It is an example of the Gandhian Satyagraha: fight for truth by non violent means. This sends a powerful message to the world

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that peace is founded on the principles of human rights, equality and justice.

Martin L. King held that true peace is to be free and have rights. This includes right against discrimination, right to education, right against exploitation, right to preserve our culture among others. These are also envisaged by the Indian Constitution and many statutes that support it.

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Thus, in conclusion we can say that peace and justice are the two threads that bind the society together & foster its progress. Examples from history across geography & at the micro individual's life show that absence of war is not sufficient to bring peace. There is a need for systemic step by step & brick by brick building of a world where 'the mind is without fear & the head is held high'

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